FOR PARENTS AND TEACHERS

Unit 1: The first six

پہلے چھ حرف

1 In this unit

Joiners vs the non-joiner alif; alif as long ā; the three short-vowel marks zabar, zer, pesh.

How long: About 3 hours for a child, 1.5 for an adult. Do 10 minutes a day, short and happy.

ن م ل ک ب ا

2 What to say and show, letter by letter

	Say	How the pen moves	Often mixed up with
ا	**alif** الف 'a' in father when long	one stroke, top to bottom	lām
ب	**be** بے 'b' in bat	start top-right, shallow bowl leftwards, hook up; dot last	nūn
ک	**kāf** کاف 'k' in kite	base stroke first, right to left, then the sloping cap on top	none yet
ل	**lām** لام 'l' in log	tall stroke down, curve into the bowl	alif
م	**mīm** میم 'm' in mat	small loop, tail down-left	none yet
ن	**nūn** نون 'n' in net	deep round bowl; dot last	be

3 How to use the sheets

1. **Trace and write**: one page per letter. Start at the dot, follow the arrow; body first, dots last.
2. **Look-alikes**: circle the same letter, then sort by dots.
3. **Join the letters**: standing letters into a joined word.
4. **Read and match**: word to meaning.
5. **Reading practice**: words, sentences, story.
6. **Dictation**: the grown-up says it, the child writes it.
7. **Unit check**: 10 questions. The answer key is the last page of the unit-check PDF; in the unit pack the keys are on the last pages.

4 How to check

- **Letters:** cover the sound, point to the letter, the child says it. 3 of 4 right is a pass.
- **Writing:** look at the start dot and the direction, not at how pretty it is. Right to left, body first, dots last.
- **Unit check:** 8 of 10 means go on. Under 8: redo the look-alike and trace sheets, try again tomorrow.
- **Praise** effort: “you started on the right”, “good dots”. One sheet a day beats five at once.

5 A 10-minute sitting

2 min warm-up: point to last time’s letters, the child says them. **5 min** the sheet of the day: say it, trace it, write it. **3 min** read it back together and end on something done well.